


# Public Surface Audit

*invisiblechildren.org and kidsatriskaction.com*

CONTENTS

**Executive Summary** . . . 2

**Purpose, Scope and Method** . . . 3

**Findings: invisiblechildren.org** . . . 5

**Findings: kidsatriskaction.com** . . . 9

**Comparative Summary** . . . 13

**Strengths and Shortcomings** . . . 15

**Opportunities for Improvement** . . . 17

6.1 First Step: Complete the Move to One Site . . . 17

6.2 Mission . . . 17

6.3 Problem . . . 18

6.4 Solutions . . . 19

6.5 Audience . . . 19

6.6 Impact . . . 20

6.7 Calls to Action . . . 21

6.8 Design . . . 21

6.9 Authenticity . . . 22

6.10 User Journey . . . 22

6.11 Decisions for the Sponsor . . . 23

6.12 Order of Work . . . 24

**Pages Reviewed** . . . 25

**User Journey Test** . . . 26

**Peer Sites Reviewed** . . . 29

SUMMARY

# Executive Summary

Kids At Risk Action (KARA) now runs two public websites. invisiblechildren.org is KARA's original website and still publishes new articles. kidsatriskaction.com went live in September 2026 as KARA's new website. This audit rates both sites in nine categories: Mission, Problem, Solutions, Audience, Impact, Calls to Action, Design, Authenticity and User Journey.

**The current site is a substantial improvement.** It rates *Exceptional* in two categories, Problem and Audience, where it does what none of three comparable child-welfare nonprofit sites does. It is *Strong* in six more and *Adequate* on Impact. It answers 97 of 100 tested visitor needs within two clicks of the homepage. The old site holds two decades of valuable reporting but rates *Weak* in five categories, and it offers a dedicated page for only 30 of the same 100 needs.

Four issues remain. The explanation of KARA's technology given on the old site has not carried over to the current one. The current site reports outputs but no outcomes. Three topics the old site covered have no page on the current site. And 23 of the current site's 40 most recent articles name their author as an account handle rather than a person.

**Key findings**

- Current site: *Exceptional* on Problem and Audience; *Strong* on Mission, Solutions, Calls to Action, Design, Authenticity and User Journey; *Adequate* on Impact.
- Old site: *Adequate* on Mission, Problem, Solutions and Authenticity; *Weak* on Audience, Impact, Calls to Action, Design and User Journey.
- The move to a single site is already under way. The largest remaining gains are the technology story, outcome reporting, and three topics the current site has dropped.

> *The current site already puts help first and protects vulnerable visitors, and the old site describes KARA's tools as curated by people rather than generating content. The remaining work is to say so plainly on the current site, in one place, and to remove language that suggests otherwise.*

SECTION 1

# Purpose, Scope and Method

This audit establishes how KARA presents itself online today, so that the Spring 2027 implementation plan starts from evidence rather than assumption.

## 1.1 Scope

Both sites were reviewed on October 15, 2026. The review covered the homepage of each site and the pages a first-time visitor is most likely to reach from it: About, programs, help and resources, donation, volunteering, featured articles, and privacy. In total, 10 pages on invisiblechildren.org and 16 on kidsatriskaction.com were examined. Appendix A lists them. Design evidence, including desktop and mobile screenshots and a contrast check of each homepage, was captured on October 16, 2026.

On October 20, 2026, the current homepage was checked again and found unchanged. The same day, both sites were crawled to measure click paths (Appendix B), samples of recent articles were checked for authorship and sourcing, and the homepages of three comparable nonprofits were reviewed to anchor the top rating (Appendix C). Every factual statement in this report was then checked again against the live sites on October 20, 2026.

## 1.2 Framework

Each site was assessed against nine categories that together describe how a nonprofit presents itself:

- **Mission** — whether a visitor can tell who KARA is and what it is for within seconds.
- **Problem** — whether the site states the problem clearly and supports it with evidence.
- **Solutions** — whether programs are described plainly and connected to the problem.
- **Audience** — whether the site recognizes who arrives and gives each a route.
- **Impact** — whether results are reported honestly and verifiably.
- **Calls to Action** — whether the next step is clear, consistent and easy to complete.
- **Design** — whether visual hierarchy, typography, imagery, color and mobile layout support the content and suit a sensitive subject.

- **Authenticity** — whether the site reads as the work of named people who know the subject: real authors, specific detail, sources, and no generic or generated filler.
- **User Journey** — how quickly a visitor with a specific need reaches the page that answers it, measured in clicks from the homepage.

## 1.3 Ratings

Each category receives one of four ratings. *Exceptional* means the category has no significant weakness and the site does something that none of the three comparable child-welfare nonprofit sites reviewed does (Section 4.2). *Strong* means the site meets the standard with only minor issues. *Adequate* means the essentials are present but a visitor must work to find them. *Weak* means a typical visitor would not get what they need. Shortcomings in Section 5 are given a severity of High, Medium or Low, so the team can prioritize.

## 1.4 Limitations

This is an expert review, not a usability study; no visitors were observed. It draws only on what each website publishes. Design findings rest on screenshots at desktop (1,366 pixels) and mobile (375 pixels) widths and an automated contrast check of each homepage; inner pages were not tested in depth. The click-path test counts links followed, including menu links, and does not measure how easily a visitor recognizes the right link. Its 100 needs were drawn from the audiences both sites name; 35 concern role-specific guidance, which only the current site offers as dedicated pages. The peer review covered homepages only and did not compare visual design. Each finding is tied to a specific page, as the project scope requires.

SECTION 2

# Findings: invisiblechildren.org

The older site is a large and sincere archive. Its difficulty is structural: twenty years of material sits in one undifferentiated layer, so the visitor must do the sorting.

## 2.1 Mission

The homepage states the mission twice in the same words: KARA is a nonprofit "action tank" that supports the people, policies and programs that improve the lives of at-risk children. The statement is clear. It competes, however, with the site's own name. The header, domain and page titles read *Invisible Children*, while the organization is *Kids At Risk Action*, and the site's link list includes the unrelated Uganda-focused organization of the same name. A first-time visitor may not know which organization they are reading.

*Assessment: Adequate. The mission is stated, but the two names dilute it.*

## 2.2 Problem

The problem is documented in depth across a blog archive reaching back to 2005 and links to investigative reports. The homepage, however, never summarizes it. There is no headline figure or plain statement of scale; a visitor must open individual articles to learn what is wrong and how large the problem is.

*Assessment: Adequate. Rich evidence, but not distilled where visitors land.*

## 2.3 Solutions

Programs are listed under Current Initiatives: the CASA Google Ad Grant initiative, the Financial Literacy and Grant Program, the book project, and the national information platform. Campus Conversations and the Deep Dive service sit elsewhere. Descriptions vary in date, length and tone. The Resource Navigator is explained well on one page, as a human-tagged, deterministic system that is not a chatbot, while the About page calls the same platform "AI driven."

*Assessment: Adequate. The programs exist and are described, but inconsistently and in scattered places.*

## 2.4 Audience

The platform page lists twelve audience groups, from caseworkers to technology developers. The homepage, however, addresses mainly lawmakers: it says KARA maintains the site in the hope that readers will share its information with their legislators, and it offers five links for finding representatives. There is no route by need. A parent worried about a child, a survivor, or a teacher deciding whether to report has no obvious first step.

*Assessment: Weak. Many audiences are named; few are guided.*

## 2.5 Impact

Impact is expressed through longevity, partner names and a list of colleges that have worked with KARA. No outputs or outcomes are counted. The About page also shows signs of internal notes published by mistake: its partner table includes an entry reading "HAMLINE MAYBE." The site's account of its own age also varies. The About page says KARA "was founded in 2001," and the volunteer page says "Since 2001"; a July 2025 post says KARA was founded "25 years ago," and posts as recent as October 5, 2026 say "more than 25 years"; the platform page and the September 2026 announcement speak of three decades and "thirty years."

*Assessment: Weak. Impact is asserted rather than shown.*

## 2.6 Calls to Action

The homepage offers about a dozen competing actions: Donate, Support a KARA Project, Check Out the Deep Dive, the resource page, the newsletter, five legislator links, Join KARA and Create Impact. Donations go to two different processors, Givebutter and Flipcause. The homepage image links to the editing address of a Google Form rather than its public address. The volunteer page asks applicants to write to "[your email]," a template placeholder.

*Assessment: Weak. Too many asks, two payment routes, and visible errors.*

## 2.7 Design

The homepage opens on a dark, close-cropped photograph of a child's face, with the mission statement set over it. Further down, a four-image slider of stock photographs includes two of children in distress: a girl covering her face and a child peering through torn cardboard. A promotional image is a generated picture, as its file name shows. For a

site that survivors and worried parents may visit, this imagery is heavy, and the generated image sits uneasily with the site's own description of the Resource Navigator, which "does not generate content."

The visual identity is inconsistent. The logo leads with *Invisible Children* in large type, with *Kids At Risk Action* in a smaller circle. Three typefaces appear on the homepage, and buttons use at least three styles, including red text on a mustard background. Green headings and links on white measure about 2.1:1 contrast, well below the WCAG minimum of 4.5:1 for body text. A sponsor logo is displayed at nearly the full width of the page, and its alternative text describes a different organization's logo. Inner pages also carry long sidebars of categories, a month-by-month archive reaching back to 2005 and lists of outside links, which crowd the main content.

On a 375-pixel phone screen, the first screen holds only the logo and part of the mission statement over the photograph, partly covered by two floating buttons and a security badge. No route to help, crisis number or quick-exit control is visible.

*Assessment: Weak. Heavy imagery, an inconsistent identity, and low contrast.*

## 2.8 Authenticity

The old site carries a real voice. All 20 of the most recent posts sampled name a person as author, Mike Tikkanen or Lawrence King. Seventeen of the 20 link to outside sources, with a median of 13.5 distinct outside links per post. The About page names the board, with short biographies and video interviews, and in his posts the founder writes in the first person about the children he has worked with.

Several things undercut that credibility. The homepage features a generated image, as its file name shows. Internal notes and template text are public: "HAMLINE MAYBE" in the partner list and "[your email]" on the volunteer page. The platform is called "AI driven" on the About page while the platform page says it is not a chatbot, and the site gives KARA's founding and age three different ways (Section 2.5).

*Assessment: Adequate. A genuine, well-sourced voice, weakened by visible errors and generated imagery.*

## 2.9 User Journey

Of 100 visitor needs tested (Appendix B), the old site has a page dedicated to 30, all within two clicks of the homepage. For another 23 it offers only a general category or archive that may contain the answer, and for 47 it offers nothing. Role-specific guidance is almost entirely missing: none of the 35 roles tested has a dedicated page.

Help is the weakest area. Of 12 urgent needs, such as what to do when a child discloses abuse, only two have a dedicated page. The child abuse hotline appears only as one link in a long list in the sidebar of inner pages, two clicks from the homepage, and no suicide or sexual assault line is offered.

*Assessment: Weak. Most needs have no page, and urgent help is the hardest to find.*

SECTION 3

# Findings: kidsatriskaction.com

The current site is designed around the visitor's situation. Most of its weaknesses are matters of consistency and completeness rather than structure.

## 3.1 Mission

The homepage opens with a single statement, "Help and facts to protect children at risk," followed by a short description of KARA as a Minnesota nonprofit working on child abuse prevention and child protection. The domain, header and page titles all carry the organization's own name. The About section adds a fuller statement: KARA puts clear, sourced information in the hands of lawmakers, professionals and families, and builds practical tools they can use.

One fact is not settled: the founding year. The homepage dates KARA's work to 1994, when the founders began as court-appointed CASA volunteers, and the Press page lists KARA as "Founded. 1994." The history timeline, however, dates the founding of invisiblechildren.org to 2000, and the site's "page not found" screen describes the blog as reaching "back to 1994," while the blog itself begins in 2005. The old site adds a third year, 2001 (Section 2.5). Mike Tikkanen has since confirmed 2000 as the founding year. The Press page and the "page not found" screen were checked on October 20, 2026.

*Assessment: Strong. Clear, apart from the founding year; nothing here yet that the peer sites do not also do.*

## 3.2 Problem

The problem is stated with numbers, and each number carries its source. The homepage cites a lifetime cost of $428 billion for one year of child maltreatment in the United States (CDC, Peterson et al., 2018). The donation page states that a child is confirmed as a victim about every 59 seconds and shows the arithmetic from federal NCANDS data. State-level figures are available for 52 states and territories.

*Assessment: Exceptional. Specific, sourced and checkable; none of the three peer sites cites sources for its homepage figures.*

## 3.3 Solutions

The Our Work page sets out the Deep Dive research service, seven free offerings, the KARA Conversations speaker program and nine ongoing programs. The Impact page explains the four main initiatives in a sentence or two each, including why each exists: for example, most CASA programs qualify for Google Ad Grants but never use them because the setup is the barrier.

The data platform page is the exception. It calls the platform "AI-driven" twice, and the Our Work page and the 2025 timeline entry use the same term, while the tools the platform page then describes are a state-by-state data record and a curated resource library. The Resource Navigator, the clearest expression of KARA's approach to technology, is not named.

*Assessment: Strong. Clear programs, with one page that misdescribes the technology.*

## 3.4 Audience

Audience is the current site's greatest advance. The homepage asks what brought the visitor and divides into three paths: *I need help*, *I want to understand* and *I want to help*. The help page addresses five situations in plain language, including "A child told me something" and "I'm in court next week." Forty-five free toolkits serve individual roles, from parents and teachers to judges and survivors. The site is also candid about its limits: its FAQ states that KARA cannot take a report or provide case work, and directs visitors to the services that can.

*Assessment: Exceptional. None of the three peer sites offers need-based paths, and none offers guidance for more than three groups.*

## 3.5 Impact

The Impact page counts what KARA has built: 1,925 articles, 45 toolkits, 11,766 vetted sources and 52 state records. Notably, it also states what it does not claim: these counts measure the size of the work, not its effect on children. A financials page links to KARA's IRS Form 990 filings. This is an honest and credible approach.

Two gaps remain. No program yet reports an outcome, such as volunteers recruited through the CASA ad grants. And the donation page's search description invites readers to "join 10,000 people giving $1 a month," while the page itself describes what 10,000 donors would fund. In search results, a goal reads as a fact. The Impact page's own search description also gives 53 state records, against 52 on the page.

*Assessment: Adequate. Honest outputs; outcomes not yet shown.*

## 3.6 Calls to Action

Actions are few and consistent: Get Help Now, Guides for Your Role, and a $1 monthly gift, with Volunteer, Contact Your Legislator and Donate grouped under Get Involved. One payment processor is used throughout. The volunteer form sits on the page itself and includes clear error messages. One ordering question deserves attention: on the homepage the $1 donation card comes before the three "What brings you here today?" paths. It follows the Get Help Now button, but a visitor looking for the right path meets an ask first.

*Assessment: Strong.*

## 3.7 Design

The current site uses a restrained palette of dark green and white, with red reserved for urgent actions. Body text is set in Atkinson Hyperlegible at 19 pixels, with Literata for headings. An automated check of the homepage's text, about 200 elements, found none below the WCAG contrast minimum on October 16 or on October 20.

On a 375-pixel phone screen, Quick Exit, the crisis bar, the headline and the Get Help Now button all appear in the first screen, with no sideways scrolling. Imagery is limited to one photograph of adult volunteers and partner logos, consistent with the site's stated policy of not adding photographs of children to blog entries.

The one weakness is emphasis. At desktop width the $1 donation card sits beside the headline and carries the strongest color on the page, so it competes with Get Help Now for attention.

*Assessment: Strong. Readable, consistent and suited to the subject.*

## 3.8 Authenticity

The current site shows its people and its evidence. The board page names each member with a short biography, most with a video interview, and the founder has his own page. Headline figures carry sources, and 36 of the 40 most recent articles link to outside sources, with a median of 8.5 distinct outside links each. The site also states its own limits: the Impact page says what it does not claim, the FAQ tells survivors what KARA cannot do, and a published policy promises corrections or removals within seven days.

Two details work against it. In 23 of the 40 most recent articles, the author is shown as an account handle, “mtikkaneninvisiblechildrenorg,” rather than a name. Of the 16 that could be matched on the old site, 15 credit Mike Tikkanen or Lawrence King there, so most names were lost in the move rather than never recorded. And the data platform page calls the work “AI-driven.” The site also under-tells one of its most distinctive facts: the Impact page notes that fifty colleges and universities have put student teams onto KARA’s programs, but this appears nowhere on the homepage.

*Assessment: Strong. Named people, sources and stated limits; author handles and “AI-driven” hold it back.*

## 3.9 User Journey

Of the same 100 visitor needs (Appendix B), the current site has a dedicated page for 97, every one within two clicks of the homepage. Forty-five are reached in one click or less, and twelve are answered on the homepage itself, including the child abuse hotline, the 988 crisis line, Quick Exit and both ways to give. All 12 urgent help needs have a dedicated page within two clicks.

Three topics have no page of their own: LGBTQ youth in care, domestic violence and children, and gun violence and children. Each had a category on the old site, so moving to the current site has narrowed what a visitor can browse by topic.

*Assessment: Strong. Fast, direct routes for almost every need; three topics lost in the move.*

SECTION 4

# Comparative Summary

Read side by side, the two sites show a clear direction of travel. The current site resolves most of the old site's structural problems, and in two categories it leads comparable organizations.

## 4.1 The Two Sites

| Category | invisiblechildren.org | kidsatriskaction.com |
|---|---|---|
| Mission | Adequate | **Strong** |
| Problem | Adequate | **Exceptional** |
| Solutions | Adequate | **Strong** |
| Audience | Weak | **Exceptional** |
| Impact | Weak | **Adequate** |
| Calls to Action | Weak | **Strong** |
| Design | Weak | **Strong** |
| Authenticity | Adequate | **Strong** |
| User Journey | Weak | **Strong** |

Table 1. Ratings by category, October 2026.

The largest gain is in Audience, from Weak to Exceptional, followed by Problem, User Journey, Calls to Action and Design. The old site speaks mainly to lawmakers, asks for many things at once and leads with distressing imagery; the current site recognizes who has arrived, offers each visitor one clear next step, and puts help in the first screen.

Impact is the one category where the current site is only adequate, and its honesty is itself a strength. It counts what it can evidence and declines to claim more. What it lacks is outcome evidence, which will require KARA to collect data it does not yet collect.

Several issues span the two sites and cannot be fixed on either alone. Both are live at the same time: the four articles published on invisiblechildren.org between October 8 and October 19, 2026 do not appear on the current site. Both list info@invisiblechildren.org as

the contact address. Each links to a different Linktree. And the old site's platform page, which names Seeds of Success as KARA's technology partner and explains how the Resource Navigator works, has no equivalent on the current site.

## 4.2 Comparison with Peer Organizations

To set the *Exceptional* standard, the homepages of three comparable child-welfare nonprofits were reviewed on October 20, 2026: Childhelp, Prevent Child Abuse America and National CASA/GAL (Appendix C).

Two practices set KARA's current site apart. None of the three peers cites a source for the figures on its homepage, while KARA cites each one. And none offers entry paths by need, or guidance across many roles: Childhelp and Prevent Child Abuse America offer neither, and National CASA/GAL offers routes for three groups only: volunteers, local programs and judges. KARA's current site also leads on crisis access. Only Prevent Child Abuse America offers a quick-exit control; Childhelp's homepage shows no hotline number, and Prevent Child Abuse America keeps its hotline numbers in a hidden panel rather than on the page.

The peers lead on impact. Each states reach or results on its homepage: Childhelp, more than 14 million children helped since 1959; Prevent Child Abuse America, more than 300,000 people reached each year and $1.81 in benefits for every dollar invested in home visiting; National CASA/GAL, a network of 890 programs in 48 states and the District of Columbia. These figures are not sourced on the homepage, but they give a visitor a sense of results that KARA's current site does not.

SECTION 5

# Strengths and Shortcomings

## 5.1 Strengths

1. **Need-first structure (current site).** Three intent-based paths, five help situations and 45 role toolkits put 97 of 100 tested needs within two clicks. None of the three peer sites offers paths by need, and none offers guidance for more than three groups.
2. **Protection for vulnerable visitors (current site).** Quick Exit, Safer Browsing, and crisis lines for 911, Childhelp, 988 and RAINN reflect a trauma-informed design.
3. **Privacy by design (current site).** No advertising or social tracking; video embeds and the Givebutter donation form load only when the visitor chooses. The privacy page names each service and what it receives.
4. **Readable, restrained design (current site).** Atkinson Hyperlegible type at 19 pixels, no contrast failures on the homepage, and no photographs of children on the homepage.
5. **Sourced evidence (current site).** Headline figures carry citations and, in one case, visible arithmetic. 11,766 sources are browsable. None of the three peer sites cites sources for its homepage figures.
6. **Candor about limits (current site).** The Impact page states what it does not claim, and the FAQ tells survivors what KARA cannot do.
7. **Depth of the archive (both sites).** Two decades of reporting and the *Invisible Children* book remain a distinctive asset.

## 5.2 Shortcomings

Severity reflects the likely effect on visitors and on KARA's credibility.

1. **Two live sites (High, under way).** New material still appears on invisiblechildren.org; visitors, search engines and partners meet two versions of KARA. The move to a single site is already in progress.
2. **The technology story did not carry over (High).** The old site's platform page names Seeds of Success as KARA's technology partner and explains that the Navigator is

curated by people and does not generate content. On the current site, Seeds of Success appears only in a footer credit and an advisor biography.

3. **"AI-driven" language (High).** The current site's data platform page, Our Work page and timeline, and the old About page, describe tools as AI-driven when they are human-curated. This contradicts KARA's own description of the Navigator.
4. **Different founding dates (Medium).** The current site gives 1994 on its homepage and Press page and 2000 on its timeline. The old site says KARA was founded in 2001 and is 25 years old, while also speaking of three decades. Old posts carry these figures as content moves across.
5. **Donation claim in search results (Medium).** "Join 10,000 people giving $1 a month" reads as a current figure.
6. **Old-domain email and draft privacy policy (Medium).** The contact address remains on invisiblechildren.org, and the privacy policy is marked as a draft.
7. **No outcome measures (Medium).** Both sites report activity rather than results, while all three peer sites state reach or results on their homepages.
8. **Three topics dropped (Medium).** LGBTQ youth, domestic violence and gun violence had categories on the old site but have no topic page on the current site.
9. **Authors shown as an account handle (Medium).** 23 of the current site's 40 most recent articles credit "mtikkaneninvisiblechildrenorg" rather than a named author.
10. **Errors on the old site (Low while it remains live).** Placeholder text, an internal note and a form-editing link are publicly visible.

SECTION 6

# Opportunities for Improvement

The goal is an Exceptional rating in every category, on a single site. Because KARA is consolidating onto kidsatriskaction.com, the tactics below are written for that site. Section 6.1 is the prerequisite; Sections 6.2 to 6.10 take each category in turn; Section 6.11 sets out decisions for the sponsor.

## 6.1 First Step: Complete the Move to One Site

*Two sites live at once; the move is under way. Target: one site.*

Every other tactic depends on there being one KARA online. The sponsor has confirmed that the old site is superseded and that redirects and search settings are being prepared. Until that work is finished, each improvement must be made twice or will be missed once.

- Publish all new articles and announcements on kidsatriskaction.com only, starting now.
- Map each old address to its new equivalent and apply permanent (301) redirects, so links, bookmarks and search rankings carry over.
- Retire the Linktree linked from the old site, so every link on the site leads to one place.
- Keep a read-only archive of the old site for KARA's records, outside public search.

**Done when** invisiblechildren.org redirects in full and no new material appears there.
*Priority: High*

## 6.2 Mission

*Adequate on the old site, Strong on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

The statement is clear on the current site. What remains is a single founding year, used on every page of both sites, one name, and a statement distinctive enough to set KARA apart from its peers.

- Agree on one mission paragraph and use it word for word on the homepage, the About page and every program page.
- Use 2000, the founding year confirmed by Mike Tikkanen, on every page: change "Founded. 1994." on the Press page, keep 1994 only as the year the founders' volunteer

work began, and correct the old site's "founded in 2001" and "25 years" wherever that content is carried over.

- Create a one-page fact sheet that fixes the founding year, the organization's age and key counts, and check every page against it.
- Keep *Invisible Children* as the title of the book only, and explain the name's history in one sentence on the About page.
- Add a line to the About page naming the access-not-creation principle, linked to the new How We Build page (Section 6.4).
- Set a quarterly content check, so outdated dates, placeholders and broken links do not accumulate again.

**Done when** a visitor meets the same mission, name and dates on every page.

*Priority: Medium*

## 6.3 Problem

*Adequate on the old site, Exceptional on the current site. Target: remain Exceptional.*

The current site already leads its peers here. Keeping that lead means keeping the figures current and showing their limits as clearly as their size.

- Maintain a short "problem in brief" block of three figures, each with its source and data year, and update it when federal NCANDS data are released each year.
- Date-stamp every headline statistic, for example "FFY 2024," so readers can judge currency at a glance.
- Link each national figure to the matching state record in KARA SIGNAL.
- State plainly what official figures do not capture, such as unreported abuse, and link to KARA's own reporting on undercounting.

**Done when** every figure on the site carries a source and a year, and none is older than the latest federal release.

*Priority: Low*

## 6.4 Solutions

*Adequate on the old site, Strong on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

Programs are clear, but the technology behind them is misdescribed and its builder is barely named.

- Publish a short "How We Build" page under Who We Are. Name Seeds of Success as KARA's technology partner, state the access-not-creation principle, and cite the site's own evidence: the deterministic Navigator, the privacy design and Quick Exit. Link it from the footer credit.
- Replace "AI-driven" on the data platform page, the Our Work page and the 2025 timeline entry with a plain account of what each tool does: human-tagged content, deterministic matching, no generated text.
- Name the Resource Navigator on the data platform page and describe it in the words the old site used.
- Give every program page the same five parts: what it is, who it is for, why it exists, how to take part, and the result to date (Section 6.6).

**Done when** no page uses "AI-driven," and a reader can learn who builds KARA's tools and why in one click from any page.

*Priority: High*

## 6.5 Audience

*Weak on the old site, Exceptional on the current site. Target: remain Exceptional.*

The current site's audience paths are its greatest strength. They have not, however, been tried with real visitors as part of this audit, and they serve English readers only.

- Run short, trauma-informed usability sessions with four groups: parents or caregivers, grandparents and other older kinship caregivers, educators, and young adults with care experience.
- Check reading level on the help pages and the toolkits for children and survivors, aiming for plain language a 12-year-old can follow.
- Review quarterly which homepage path visitors choose, using the privacy-preserving analytics already in place, and adjust the order to match.

- Translate the help page and crisis numbers into the languages most used by Minnesota families, beginning with Spanish.

**Done when** each path has been tried by real members of its audience and the help page is available in at least one language besides English.

*Priority: Medium*

## 6.6 Impact

*Weak on the old site, Adequate on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

This is the largest gap. The current site counts outputs honestly but reports no outcomes. Reaching full marks means collecting evidence KARA does not yet gather.

- State on the Impact page, with sources, the reach KARA can already evidence, as all three peer sites do on their homepages.
- Define one verifiable outcome per program, for example CASA programs enrolled in the ad-grant initiative and volunteer inquiries they received, Deep Dive requests answered, or Financial Literacy participants who complete a cohort.
- Publish each outcome on its program page with its source and date, keeping the current practice of stating what is not claimed.
- Issue a short annual impact note that links outcomes to the Form 990, so a donor can follow money in to work done.
- Add brief stories from volunteers, partners and educators, with consent and under the site's existing policy on naming children.
- Reword the donation page's search description so 10,000 monthly donors reads as a goal, not a current figure.

**Done when** every program reports at least one outcome with a source, and the Impact page is updated each year.

*Priority: High*

## 6.7 Calls to Action

*Weak on the old site, Strong on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

Actions on the current site are few and consistent. Full marks require putting help before asks, and closing the loop after a visitor acts.

- Move the help paths above the $1 donation module on the homepage, so a visitor in distress meets help first.
- Give each page one primary action, with secondary actions grouped below it.
- Confirm every form with an on-screen message and an email stating what happens next and when, for example a Deep Dive response time.
- Move the contact address to the kidsatriskaction.com domain.
- Finalize the privacy policy, still marked as a draft, so visitors who give or submit a form know how their data is handled.

**Done when** every page has one clear next step and every form tells the visitor what will happen and when.
*Priority: Medium*

## 6.8 Design

*Weak on the old site, Strong on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

The current site's design is strong. Full marks require writing it down, so that it survives future edits by volunteers and new pages keep to it.

- Write a one-page style guide that records the palette, the two typefaces, button styles and the contrast minimum, and share it with every contributor.
- Extend the existing rule on photographs of children from the blog to every page, and add two more: no generated images presented as real, and alternative text checked by a person.
- Use the KARA logo, colors and type on every page, and keep *Invisible Children* as the book's title only.
- Move the donation card below the help paths at desktop width, and check key pages at 375 pixels after each change so the crisis bar and Get Help Now stay in the first screen.

**Done when** a style guide exists, and every page follows the same identity and imagery rules.
*Priority: Medium*

## 6.9 Authenticity

*Adequate on the old site, Strong on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

The current site shows named people, sources and its own limits. Exceptional means removing the small signals that read as automated, and telling plainly what makes KARA distinctive.

- Show a named author on every article, and replace the account handle on the 23 recent articles that display it, starting from the author names the old site records for most of them.
- Give every article a short sources list, so the homepage promise of "a source for every number" holds on every page.
- Tell the student and volunteer model on the homepage and About page: the fifty colleges and universities whose student teams work on KARA's programs, with named examples.
- Say on the How We Build page (Section 6.4) where people write and decide, and where tools assist.

**Done when** every article names a person and lists its sources, and the student model is visible from the homepage.

*Priority: Medium*

## 6.10 User Journey

*Weak on the old site, Strong on the current site. Target: Exceptional.*

The current site reaches 97 of 100 tested needs within two clicks. Exceptional means closing the three gaps and confirming the routes with real visitors, not only by counting clicks.

- Restore topic pages for LGBTQ youth, domestic violence and gun violence, drawing on the existing articles.
- Re-run the 100-need test after each major homepage change, starting with the mock-up now in review.

- Time real visitors, including older visitors, completing five common tasks, such as finding the hotline and a role toolkit, and set a target for each.

**Done when** all 100 needs have a dedicated page within two clicks, and timed tests with real visitors meet their targets.

*Priority: Medium*

## 6.11 Decisions for the Sponsor

Four choices shape the next phase. Each lists the options considered; the first is recommended.

**1. Where the technology story lives**

a. A "How We Build" page under Who We Are, linked from the footer credit. (*Recommended*)

b. A section on the existing About page.

c. A short band on the homepage that links to either of the above.

**2. How to report outcomes**

a. One verified outcome on each program page. (*Recommended*)

b. An annual impact report linked from the Impact page.

c. A live dashboard on the Impact page.

**3. How to restore the three dropped topics**

a. Add topic pages alongside the existing eleven. (*Recommended*)

b. Add them as filters within related topic pages.

c. Rely on site search.

**4. Where the donation request sits on the homepage**

a. Below the help paths. (*Recommended*)

b. Beside the headline, with less emphasis.

c. In a band near the foot of the page.

## 6.12 Order of Work

Three actions carry the most weight and should lead the Spring 2027 implementation plan: completing the move to one site (6.1), telling the technology story and correcting the "AI-driven" language (6.4), and introducing outcome reporting (6.6). Restoring the three topics (6.10), fixing article authorship (6.9) and using the confirmed founding year everywhere (6.2) are quick wins that can proceed alongside them.

Nothing in this report is to be published on KARA's behalf until Sam Clayton and Jarred VanHorn have signed off.

APPENDIX A

# Pages Reviewed

All pages were viewed on October 15, 2026, and every statement drawn from them was checked again on October 20, 2026. Design screenshots and contrast checks were captured on October 16, 2026. Two further pages cited in Section 3.1, the Press page and the “page not found” screen, were checked on October 20, 2026.

### kidsatriskaction.com

- Homepage
- Get help
- Toolkits
- Our Work
- National Child Abuse Information and Solutions Platform
- Impact
- Research and Data
- Who We Are
- Since 1994 (history)
- People and board
- Financials and accountability
- Get Involved
- Volunteer
- Donate
- Frequently asked questions
- Privacy policy (draft)

### invisiblechildren.org

- Homepage
- About Us + Contact
- National platform and Resource Navigator
- Educate and Inform
- Featured Articles
- Campus Programs
- Deep Dive
- Volunteer
- KARA Nonprofit Fully Funded Programs (July 17, 2025)
- Announcement of kidsatriskaction.com (September 17, 2026)

APPENDIX B

# User Journey Test

Each row is one visitor need. The figures are the clicks needed to reach a page that answers it, starting from the homepage; 0 means the homepage itself answers it. For the old site, "cat." marks a need served only by a general category or archive, and a dash means no page was found. Both sites were crawled on October 20, 2026.

| Visitor need | Current site | Old site |
|---|---|---|
| **Getting help** | | |
| A child is in danger right now: who do I call? | 0 | 2 (cat.) |
| Find the child abuse hotline number | 0 | 2 (cat.) |
| Find a suicide crisis line for a teenager | 0 | – |
| Find a sexual assault hotline | 1 | – |
| A child told me about abuse: what do I say? | 1 | – |
| Do I have to report what I saw? | 1 | – |
| How do I make a report in my state? | 1 | – |
| I was abused as a child: where do I start? | 2 | – |
| I have juvenile court next week | 2 | – |
| Find shelter, food or legal aid near me | 1 | 1 |
| I'm not sure what I need | 2 | 1 |
| Leave the site quickly on a shared device | 0 | – |
| **Guidance for my role** | | |
| Guidance for parents | 2 | – |
| Guidance for foster parents | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for a relative of an abused child | 2 | – |
| Guidance for a friend of an abused child | 2 | – |
| Guidance for teachers | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for principals and administrators | 2 | – |
| Guidance for school counselors | 2 | – |
| Guidance for school boards | 2 | – |
| Guidance for childcare workers | 2 | – |
| Guidance for mandated reporters | 2 | – |
| Guidance for social workers | 2 | – |
| Guidance for child investigators | 2 | – |
| Guidance for CASA guardians ad litem | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for adoption agencies | 2 | – |
| Guidance for law enforcement | 2 | – |
| Guidance for police investigators | 2 | – |
| Guidance for judges | 2 | – |

| Visitor need | Current site | Old site |
|---|---|---|
| Guidance for attorneys | 2 | – |
| Guidance for prosecutors | 2 | – |
| Guidance for corrections professionals | 2 | – |
| Guidance for physicians | 2 | – |
| Guidance for therapists | 2 | – |
| Guidance for psychiatrists | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for public health professionals | 2 | – |
| Guidance for faith communities | 2 | – |
| Guidance for journalists | 2 | – |
| Guidance for state lawmakers | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for governors | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for mayors and county administrators | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Guidance for county and state auditors | 2 | – |
| Guidance for researchers | 2 | – |
| Guidance for volunteers who work with children | 2 | – |
| Guidance for a teenager who was abused | 2 | – |
| Guidance for an adult abused as a child | 2 | – |
| Guidance for survivors working in helping professions | 2 | – |
| **Understanding the issue** | | |
| Child abuse numbers for Minnesota | 1 | 2 (cat.) |
| Child abuse numbers for another state (Texas) | 1 | 2 (cat.) |
| National child maltreatment figures | 1 | 2 (cat.) |
| The cost of child abuse to society | 0 | 2 (cat.) |
| Learn about foster care | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Learn about trauma and ACEs | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Children's mental health | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Juvenile justice | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Schools and education | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| How CPS works and where it fails | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Child deaths known to CPS | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| What prevention works | 2 | – |
| Child welfare legislation and policy | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| Family court and termination of parental rights | 2 | – |
| Stories from survivors | 2 | 2 (cat.) |
| LGBTQ youth in care | – | 2 |
| Domestic violence and children | – | 2 |
| Gun violence and children | – | 2 |
| Child abuse news from other countries | 1 | 1 |
| Browse every source KARA cites | 1 | 1 |

| Visitor need | Current site | Old site |
|---|---|---|
| The state-by-state data platform | 1 | 1 |
| **Read, watch and listen** | | |
| Read the latest articles | 1 | 1 |
| Read articles from a past year | 2 | 2 |
| Search the site for a topic | 0 | 0 |
| Watch KARA's videos | 1 | 2 (cat.) |
| Read the Invisible Children book | 1 | 1 |
| Listen to the book as audio | 2 | – |
| See KARA's next book project | 1 | 1 |
| Sign up for the weekly email | 1 | 1 |
| **About KARA** | | |
| What does KARA do? | 0 | 0 |
| Who runs KARA? | 1 | 1 |
| Who is the founder? | 2 | 1 |
| KARA's history | 1 | 2 |
| See KARA's finances and tax filings | 1 | – |
| Is KARA a registered nonprofit? | 0 | 0 |
| Who sponsors KARA? | 0 | 0 |
| Read the privacy policy | 1 | 1 |
| Find a contact email | 0 | 1 |
| Press and media inquiries | 1 | – |
| Ask KARA to remove a child's name | 1 | – |
| **Getting involved** | | |
| Give $1 a month | 0 | 1 |
| Make a one-time gift | 0 | 1 |
| Give by check | 1 | – |
| Volunteer with KARA | 1 | 1 |
| Become a CASA volunteer | 1 | 1 |
| Contact my legislator | 1 | 1 |
| Invite a speaker | 1 | 1 |
| Host a campus conversation | 1 | 1 |
| Share my own story | 1 | – |
| Partner as an organization | 1 | – |
| Sponsor KARA as a company | 1 | – |
| Collaborate on research as a university | 1 | – |
| Request free research (Deep Dive) | 1 | 1 |

Summary: the current site reaches 97 needs within two clicks (45 within one); the old site has a dedicated page for 30, a general category or archive for 23, and nothing for 47.

APPENDIX C

# Peer Sites Reviewed

Homepages viewed on October 20, 2026, to set the Exceptional standard. Only the homepage of each was reviewed.

- Childhelp
- Prevent Child Abuse America
- National CASA/GAL Association for Children